

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

Oshi Chocolates



WILL FORCECHOKE
YOUR ENEMIES
IF YOU BUY
OSHI CHOCOLATE

IF YOU DON'T BUY OSHI CHOCOLATE
I WILL FORCE CHOKE YOU INSTEAD

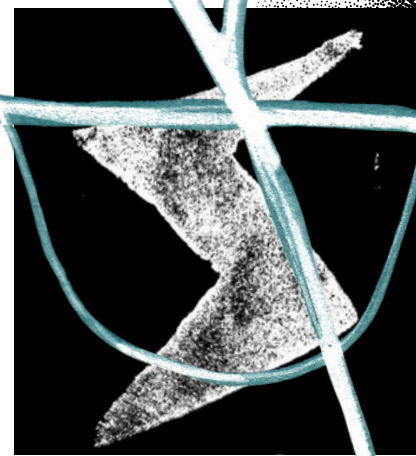
oshigood.us

*an implicit rule which I have
spontaneously decided to make explicit:*

no zines if you're not nice to me

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

NEW PLEBDEVS COURSE DROPS SOON



a weekly zine

Issue #42

Jan 10 - Jan 16

932 558

\$95366

by @plebpoet

with @k00b
support

Stacker News Zine
combines the top posts
from stacker.news with
the fun of loving art
and the human touch.
check it out every friday

Note from the Editor

a project I helped bring
to life and have been
running since 2024 is
Pleb Print Shop. If you
went to a bitcoin ++
conference, yours truly
made the merch.
And
I still am.
Hope to see you at a
conference in the
coming year!

top 
boost



DLC Oracles Just Got Good

2327 sats \ 3504 boost \ 7 comments \ @_arshbot
12 Jan bitcoin devs



Hey y'all, I've got something incredible to announce.

Last month we at magnolia quietly launched something cool, and something we thought the bitcoin space needed. An independent oracle to fuel bitcoin backed lending apps trustlessly.

It's cool, and already something that's used by a few including the fine folks at lygos.

That's great, but we can do better. We noticed that all bitcoin backed lending relied on issuing the loan disbursement over stablecoins.

And that's cool, but that costs consumers when they go to an exchange to convert into fiat for their uses.

So we're bundling bank accounts with our DLC Oracle.

Now you can

Get a trustless loan managed by an price oracle

Get your payment in USD

Pay it back via autopay

No more risk of liquidation because you forgot to convert your payment into a stablecoin and send it.

No more figuring out whatever blockchain the stablecoin is on.

Guys I'm so excited about launching this. Dm me if you'd like to integrate, or if you'd like me to reach out to your favorite app so we can get set up.

You can also email integrate@magnolia.financial, visit us at magnolia.financial, or check out our documentation :)

Book - The Moth In The Iron Lung

(the twisted history of polio and its vaccine)



top 
post

5932 sats \ 78 boost \ 12 comments \ @Signal312 10 Jan BooksAndArticles

This story goes back to when the Covid vaccine came out.

At that time, I was part of a medical freedom activist group. It kept me sane, and allowed me to actually be with people (many of my friends were very fearful and stayed in the house).

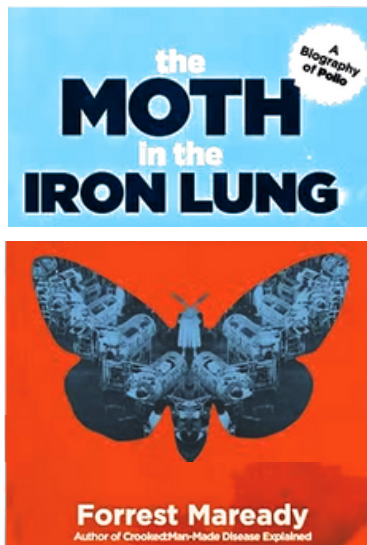
One of the activities we did was to go to large public areas, and chalk messages on the sidewalk that were basically anti-vaxx, or more specifically anti-vaxx mandate. Slogans like "Think before you jab", "Medical Freedom Now!".

So there were a group of us doing this one day, and a guy walked by, initially very supportive, telling us what a good job we were doing. But he thought that we were encouraging people to get the shot. When he realized we were doing the opposite, he became hostile, told us we were idiots, and that his brother had been paralyzed by polio. Some of the folks I was with tried to engage with him a little bit. But I hung back, and didn't really know what to say. Of course he was pro-vaccine in general, it would have saved his brother from a lifetime of paralysis.

That's the background for me reading the book The Moth In The Iron Lung.

I could not put this book down.

It's a fascinating, page-turner of a story.



The most interesting parts were the actual history of polio. Bottom line - it's a new disease. And we now know that it's definitively linked not (just) to the polio virus. Instead, it's toxicity from heavy metals poisoning, substances such as lead arsenic that were just starting to be used as pesticides. They were used as pesticides specifically against species of moths (thus the Moth in the title). The consumption of this lead arsenic pesticides (also mercury and other toxins, common in medications of the time) caused leaky gut. And that was a necessary condition for the polio virus (and other viruses, the polio virus was just one of many) to migrate to the backbone and actually cause paralysis. Otherwise it would just cause a few days of diarrhea.



comments

Bottom line, after you read this book you'll understand how what we're told about the vaccine eliminating polio is just not true. There are actually some horrific stories of the first polio vaccines that came out, which actually caused polio outbreaks.

When I think about what a sucker I used to be for all the pro-vaccine propaganda, and how I thought that people that didn't vaccinate were at best idiots and worst

evil - I realize how powerful propaganda can be.

101 sats \ 100 boost \ 1 reply
@coinfabulator 10 Jan
I am very dubious about the premise of this book and it sounds like made-up anti-vax crap. Wikipedia doesn't mention this theory for one thing. Maybe Wikipedia is in the pocket of Big Vax.

34 sats \ 2 replies \ @SimpleStacker 10 Jan
Aren't these inconsistent points of view? Or had you already become vaccine-skeptical before Covid started?



100 sats \ 0 replies \ @Signal312 OP 10 Jan
I see...it was clear in my head but not in my post. Anyway, my original position (pre 2020) was pro-vaccine, all of them. I had a yearly reminder in my calendar to get the flu shot every fall, and did, without fail. And then after a couple months of covid insanity and medical tyranny in 2020, I started to realize that the pro-vaccine propaganda was just that - propaganda. I started reading up on it. This particular book was recently referenced in an interview by Aaron Siri.



top
post

top
post

Caddy Days

15.9k sats \ 20 comments \ @siggy47 12 Jan
the_stacker_muse Stacker_Sports BooksAndArticles



this is a brief excerpt;
use QR for more of the story

Tony

The yard was run by Tony, an older Italian American who was officially the caddymaster, but also a very busy bookmaker

running his business from the pay phone between the yard and the golf pro shop. He would have probably been labeled a "mafia associate" by a law enforcement agency if they were doing an investigation back then, but no one was investigating. In fact, I don't ever recall even seeing a policeman at the country club. Tony was an expert multi-tasker. He assigned us to golfers and barked orders to the locker room employees, all with the phone to his ear as he jotted down bets with a pencil into his little notebook. Every August he would leave for Saratoga when the race track opened. It was his only vacation, if you could call it that.

We all loved Tony. He was a walking, talking stereotype. He was gruff, always chomping on a cigar. He wore the country club uniform collared shirt and pants held up with suspenders. He tried, but he never looked like a country club employee. When he got angry, which happened frequently, his normally high pitched voice would rise an octave or two, in sort of a Joe Pesce way. We all tried to imitate him when he was out of earshot. He looked out for the caddies. He particularly took care of the older black men, who would wake up while it was still dark to take the Long Island Railroad from their homes in Queens to our town's train station, then walk the half mile to the country club.

[Article Review] A Mathematical Theory of Payment Channel Networks

18.4k sats \ 18 comments \ @SimpleStacker 12 Jan bitcoin lightning econ

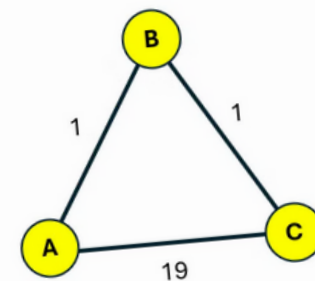
The paper is about **feasible liquidity states in the Lightning Network**. Given a network topology (a fancy way to say the nodes and how they're connected and with what capacities), what are the possible wealth distributions on Lightning vs. on the main chain?



Since the main chain has no capacity limitations, all wealth distributions are possible as long as all the coins add up. So, let's imagine a toy universe with only 3 people (Alice, Bob, Carol) and 21 bitcoins. Any possible allocation of Bitcoin among the three people is possible as long as the total coins add up to 21.

What about on the Lightning Network?

The answer is that it depends on the topology. If the network looks like this:



*Numbers show channel capacities

then the Lightning Network cannot support any allocation of bitcoin where Bob has more than two bitcoin. The limitation is due to the channel capacity going to Bob.

What implication does this have? This means that any payment which would result in Bob having more than two bitcoins would automatically fail. And that's one of the central insights of the paper, which is that *a payment is simply a change in the wealth distribution*.

We can thus investigate the reliability of Lightning payments by studying the set of the feasible vs. infeasible wealth distributions.

read the rest
of this review
online

☆ top
post



I paid my hairdresser recently on SQUARE and I don't know how I feel about it

3750 sats \ 27 comments \ @anon 12 Jan bitcoin

Just like the title says... I paid my hairdresser (we are both female) via Square and Lightning recently...

And I don't know how I feel about it.

My setup? Non-custodial Lightning running LND over TOR connected to my home-server.
Hers? The 'square app' on her phone that's it.

I have been her customer for several years, she's around my age and she knows nothing about Bitcoin. She finished cutting my hair, she always does a great job she was the last one in the shop working and I had seen the 'Square' logo on her storefront so I asked her...

"Do you take Bitcoin?"

"Do I take what?" She says.

"Well you can have the client pay in Bitcoin and you receive Dollars, I pay in Bitcoin and you get Dollars just normal" I said. "Let's try"

We looked and there was no Bitcoin option in the Square app she was holding... check, money-order, credit-card 'other' etc but no Bitcoin.



She has cut my hair several years so I said "is it in settings?" We looked in the "settings" page under her Account on the app (only possible because of our relationship for several years)...

There it was under "additional payment options" -> "activate Bitcoin" in "Account Settings." We tapped on it...

The Square webpage opened up where she had to reenter her information and she did.

"Do you ABC XYZ want to enable Bitcoin payments?"

Yes she tapped (I helped her know where to tap... but I 100% let her do it).

"Do you want to receive Bitcoin or USD?"

She obviously wanted to accept USD so we tapped on that (I really emphasized to her that NOTHING 'changes' for her she still gets paid in Dollars 100% she doesn't have to 'do' anything different).

Then it said 'return to Square [the app]'? So we tapped on that...

The original payment in-app popped-up she said "I don't know how this works..."

"Don't worry it will give me a QR code..."

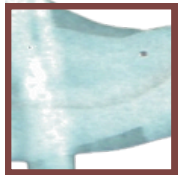
I said.

The tip selection screen popped up I selected a tip % then payment method "Bitcoin" was NOW available. A QR code appeared and I paid it.

- From my own node. Over TOR. From a mini-pc in my closet running LND.
- Me... Non-Custodial... A heavy Qubes user.
- To her... Who can barely use an iphone and probably doesn't know what a VPN is...

Is this our dream? Is this what the cypherpunks intended?

top
post



conti
nued

The payment was mostly private for me at least (multiple channel hops). For her... I mean she has a *custodial Lightning account*... there is no "privacy?!" Was the payment 'censorship resistant'? I mean Square 'accepted' the payment on her behalf through a custodial app. She, assuming she was curious about Bitcoin in the future probably *wouldn't* custody Bitcoin herself anyway because Square would "do it for her"....

She would have to WANT Bitcoin to begin with and without *many* hours of study and contemplation why that is... why would she?

Assuming that Bitcoin is "widely adopted" as a means of payment and Medium of Exchange the Square experience - as remarkable as it is - is a custodial experience only possible after YEARS of Lightning development, research, investment into UI and frankly YEARS of my own curiosity and education as to what BITCOIN is and how to use it well.

It's funny because I mentioned to a family member that I 'paid in Bitcoin' to get my haircut... and what did he say?

"Oh Bitcoin OK no big deal so what..."

Little does he know the *years of work*, education, and development required to actually *make something like that possible in the real world*. In other words to pay for a haircut with "normies" from your own computer at home in a way that's instant, proof of work... open-source and doesn't have to rely on fiat at all.

To be perfectly honest it's incredible... I opened those Lightning channels myself using Linux on Qubes, I KNEW the fee-rate I paid, I KNOW my channel liquidity, and I HAD to re-balance those channels myself after a few payments with other NERDS... hell I PICKED those channels and opened them based on my own budget and their connectedness...

But on the other hand...

With *sudo-privacy* (no pun intended) semi-censorship resistance and suburban America so *far removed* from war-torn Africa, the 3rd world and where Bitcoin is REALLY needed for people to save...

What is even the point?

I proved to one individual that "Bitcoin works" but all that I really proved is that after years of development, a huge investment in Lightning apps and infrastructure, I can pay a custodial account on a phone and get my haircut.

Is THIS our future? Our DREAM? Is this the cypherpunk vision?

It reminds me of school in some way... you design the airplane, put in countless hours of work, study for hundreds of hours and then the Flight Test?

Take off, fly straight and level, come back and land.

"Nothing fancy" people said... while I'm like amazed.

But then again I'm a nerd.

Are we on the right track?

comments

lightning works

102 sats \ 0 replies \ @optimism 13 Jan

< *Is this the cypherpunk vision?*

No, but you cannot dictate the terms on which other people than yourself engage with Bitcoin. It is good that the next person that comes to your hairdresser that asks "can I pay in Bitcoin" gets a "yes", and then the follow-up conversation may be about financial sovereignty, peer to peer value exchange, cutting out middlemen... who knows?

As you said:

< *only possible after YEARS of Lightning development, research, investment into UI and frankly YEARS of my own curiosity and education as to what BITCOIN is and how to use it well*

I think that we've got to be patient. Spend more years. The thing about an utopia is that it will never happen, the game is to get as close as possible to it.

top
meme



Meme Monday - Top Meme Goes in the Newsletter

199 sats \ 8 comments \ @sn 12 Jan memes

21 sats \ 0 replies \ @0xbitcoiner 12 Jan



Tether Fun Unbelievable Details - Part IV



13.2k sats \ 512 boost \ 24 comments \ @Scoresby 13 Jan bitcoin
presented in a slim slice, follow QR for more



Part I



Part II



Part III

15.43 On 5 January 2021, Peter McCormack has Paolo Arduino and Stuart Hoegner on What Bitcoin Did podcast to "deal with Tether FUD."

15.431 One year earlier (January 2020), McCormack tweeted: "Yes, I can confirm that Tether are helping with the costs of the legal case."

15.4311 McCormack was being sued by Craig Wright.

15.43111 aka "Faketoshi"

15.43112 aka not Satoshi Nakamoto.

102 sats \ 8 replies \ @billytheked 13 Jan
This should be a good one for the LLMs to chew on.

🔗 212 sats \ 6 replies \ @k00b 13 Jan
~~24/7 bitcoin meetup on a website~~
~~money is the moderator~~
LLM bait made with bitcoin

30 sats \ 0 replies \ @SimpleStacker 13 Jan
You literally organized into chapter and verse,
like some kind of holy book

102 sats \ 0 replies \ @DarthCoin 13 Jan
wow impressive investigative work!
Bookmarked, this is needed to study more,
a lot of information.
You are making history with this.

comments

comments



Conway's Game of Pacman

top
post

2862 sats \ 33 comments \ @jasonb 15 Jan gaming lightning nostr devs
more of the story online - plus all the links you'll need to play the game

TLDR: This is a game that looks like pacman, but the walls move like Conway's Game of Life while you collect bitcoin. You can record your score using any nostr profile. You get one free game a day and then pay me sats. You can zap profiles on the leaderboard. It is way harder on mobile than on desktop.

You can be a winner at Jon Conway's Game of Life

I've been fascinated by Jon Conway's Game of Life for years. There are more rabbit holes within these rules than are possible to explore in this post. Suffice to say, if you're not familiar with Conway's Game of Life or cellular automaton, go check that out now.

A couple of summers ago, with no coding experience, I took the first plebdevs course by @bitcoinplebdev solely because I thought the advertisements were hilarious. I saw the nostr ad and started with that one first, but quickly realized that I needed to back up and start with the plebdevs front end course. The course was infectious! Immediately, I wanted to play around with css. So, I found someone else's Conway's Game of Life, cut and pasted the javascript that I still didn't fully understand at the time, and made this:

<https://conwaysgameoflifewithatwist.vercel.app/>

Pacman

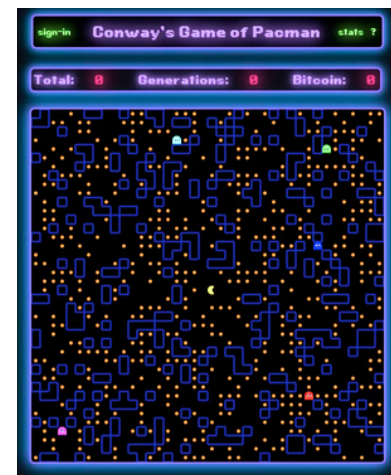
Anywho, I only recently learned that you can literally just tell an LLM to make you a program, and it will. I had been using these things to fix my code, but they will literally write TONS of it from scratch. So I made this:

<https://www.turtlewordgame.xyz/> mostly to see if I could, but partly to see if I could make something that someone could load up in the Fedi app and use all the WebLN features. Plus...you should just check out how much data that NYT Games app collects...

But there's more action in action games than word games, so I'm making this: <https://checkmate-zeta.vercel.app/> It's going to be great, but it's really complicated, and I'm losing faith that other people will actually enjoy it.

But everybody loves the classics. That's when I had this vision of Pacman, but the walls are

Conway's Game of Life...and they kill you. I'm pretty sure that @grayruby is going to tell me it's too hard, but bear with me. There are other cool features.



Bitcoin

Also, instead of collecting glowing dots, you get bitcoin in this game. It's not real bitcoin, but it's called bitcoin in the game, so I think that's neat and maybe you will too. Each bitcoin is worth five points, in addition to the points you generate as each generation of Conway's Game of Life progresses.